Lu Rou Fan

Diced pork belly braised in soy and spices, over rice.

SERVES **4** · ACTIVE **20 MINUTES** · TOTAL **2 HOURS**

INGREDIENTS

1 lb (450 g)	skin-on pork belly, cut into 1/2 in pieces
2 tsp	neutral oil
25 g	rock sugar (or 1 1/2 tbsp granulated sugar)
1 small	onion, diced (or 2 to 3 shallots)
8	shiitake mushrooms, fresh or dried, cut into 1/2 in dice
1/4 cup	Shaoxing wine (60 ml)
3 tbsp	light soy sauce (45 ml)
2 tbsp	dark soy sauce (30 ml)
2 cups	water (475 ml)
4	hard-boiled eggs, peeled (optional)
	steamed white rice, to serve

Spice bundle

3	star anise
1	cinnamon stick (Chinese cassia)
6	whole cloves
3	bay leaves
2 tsp	Sichuan peppercorns
2 pieces	dried tangerine peel
2 slices	fresh ginger

METHOD

1. Tie all the spice bundle ingredients into a square of cheesecloth with kitchen string, so they can be fished out whole before reducing.
2. Bring enough water to cover the pork to a boil. Blanch the pork belly **1 minute**, drain, and rinse off any scum.
3. Warm the oil in a wok over low heat and add the sugar. Once it starts to melt, add the onion, raise the heat to medium-high and stir-fry **1 minute**. Add the mushrooms and stir-fry **2 minutes** more.
4. Add the pork, Shaoxing wine, both soy sauces and the water, and bring to a boil. Drop in the spice bundle and the eggs, then turn the heat to its lowest setting.
5. Simmer **1 1/2 hours**, stirring now and then so nothing catches on the bottom. Keep it at the barest simmer so the sauce isn't gone before the final reduction.
6. Once the pork is falling apart, remove the spice bundle. Raise the heat to medium-high and reduce, stirring occasionally, about **5 minutes**, until the sauce coats a spoon but there's still plenty to soak the rice.
7. Spoon the pork and sauce over steamed rice, with an egg (halved) in each bowl.

NOTES

- Keep the skin and don't trim the fat. They melt into the sauce and give it body; lean pork makes it thin.
- Dried shiitakes taste stronger than fresh. Soak them in warm water until soft, about **30 minutes**, before dicing.
- A longer braise only helps, and the dish adapts well to a slow cooker. Reduce the sauce on the stove at the end either way.
- Close cousin of Shanghai red-cooked pork (hong shao rou), but cut small so it becomes a meat sauce for rice rather than chunks.

PER SERVING

698 cal · 13 g carbs · 20 g protein · 68 g fat · 1167 mg sodium

SOY, GINGER & FERMENT
PROTEIN MAIN · WOK, LOW BRAISE
TAIWAN

Adapted from Judy Leung, The Woks of Life, thewoksoflife.com/lu-rou-fan-taiwanese-braised-pork-rice-bowl. Method rewritten and condensed for personal kitchen use.